LVNA
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VILLAGER

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- Recap of the October Meeting -

For our October meeting, we invited Alpana Agarwal, the Founder and President of Helping Hands of Silicon Valley (HHSV). HHSV is a local non-profit of volunteers helping our local community. Starting in 2020, it's a young organization, but it has already helped support our local unhoused residents, farmers in Monterey County, people displaced by the fires in Santa Cruz, and distributed hygiene kits to people in Sunnyvale. Below are some meeting highlights:

- HHSV provides hot meals (lunch, dessert, and snacks) to people on Saturdays and Sundays. The food is prepared fresh that morning, and recent offerings have ranged from simple pasta dishes to butter chicken.
- While there are more unhoused folks in North Sunnyvale than other parts of Sunnyvale, most of the unhoused people in Sunnyvale are from the Bay Area. In fact, the first people to set up in Lakewood Park are from the Lakewood and Fairwood neighborhood.

- If you see someone who is unhoused, please share HSSV's contact information with them. You can also refer people to the Bill Wilson Center, which supports primarily young adults, LGBTQ+, and foster youth.
- HomeFirst is a large non-profit based in Santa Clara that works closely to support affordable housing. However, they have a limited number of case workers, so it's hard for the case workers to build relationships with all of the unhoused residents. Sunnyvale Community Services is focused on preventing homeless and helping to keep people in their homes.HHSV tries to fill this gap by working in tandem with these larger non-profits.
- When a case worker first makes contact with an unhoused person, they try to understand what that person needs. Case workers use a VI-SPDAT questionnaire to document these needs. However, the questionnaire asks very personal things (e.g., if someone has been a victim of a crime or been forced to do things against their will). Many unhoused people (like all of us) are hesitant to share vulnerabilities with a case worker, which means unhoused people often underreport their risks. As a result, the unhoused person scores lower on the VI-SPDAT and is eligible for fewer services than they should be. A copy of the VI-SPDAT can be found here: https://pehgc.org/wp-content/uploads/2016/09/VI-SPDAT-v2.01-Single-US-Fillable.pdf



- HHSV works to remove the barriers to help. They support people with things like food stamps, obtaining IDs, accessing medical care, and getting social security numbers. These things may seem trivial, but for someone who is unhoused (and has no address), it can be extremely difficult to access this support.
- Many people dislike staying in a shelter. A shelter is rows of beds with no personal space, so you must sleep next to strangers. There is a risk of people stealing or rummaging through your belongings. Shelters also often have curfews and restrictions (like no drug or alcohol use or no pets allowed). Additionally, many shelters are closed during the day, so residents have to pack up all their belongings and find somewhere to go until they are allowed back into the shelter in the evening. Because of the unideal environment, even if we had enough shelter beds for our entire unhoused population, it's

unlikely that all of our unhoused residents would choose to live in a shelter. Similarly, even designating a large parking lot as a place for people to pitch their tents is not ideal, since people would still be living in close proximity to strangers. Many unhoused people prefer to live in smaller communities where they know everyone. For safety, privacy, and more reasons, tiny houses or motel rooms are preferred housing options.

- Sunnyvale's shelter is only available to unhoused people who have been referred.Therefore, an unhoused person cannot show up at the Sunnyvale shelter and get a bed. They must go through the assessment, be referred by someone, and there has to be a bed available for them).

For more information on HHSV or to volunteer with them, visit their website https://www.helpinghandssv.org/about-us, email them at info@helpinghandssv.org, or call them at (408) 663-1812.

- Lakewood Park Tree Walk -



Tree #5 (Purple Leaf Plum)

In April, we highlighted Tree #1, the London Plane tree. From there, Tree #2 was the Italian Stone Pine, visible from the same spot as Tree #1. We then walked northeast, stopping at a concrete bench on your left for Tree #3, the Crape Myrtle. We continued our leisurely pace, arriving at Tree #4, the Saucer Magnolia, in August. After a rest for a few months, we are finally at the fifth tree on SUFA (Sunnyvale Urban Forest Advocates) Lakewood Park Tree Walk - the Purple Leaf Plum.

Since you probably don't remember where you were in August, start today at the corner of Lakechime Drive and Silverlake Dr. Look south (towards the playground). Still outside the fence is where you will gaze upon the Purple Leaf Plum, aka *Prunus cersifera*, aka the cherry plum tree.

The Purple Leaf Plum grows up to 25 feet and is a deciduous tree native to Asia and Southeast Europe. Its leaves are dark red or purple, and the trees lose its leaves in early fall (usually by end of September). Its flowers - white or pale pink - emerge in early spring. The trees don't produce fruit every year, but in years when they do produce fruit, the fruit comes in late summer. Good news! You can eat the dark purple fruit (yes, it's a variety of plum) that the tree produces. The SUFA notes say the fruit is sour but works well in jams. For the more adventuresome, try soaking them in vodka and sugar for two weeks to create plum vodka.

The trees need weekly watering when they are getting established, but once they have been established, they are somewhat drought resistant. However, they are susceptible to a lot of diseases and pests. Diseases like black not, leaf curl, fireblight, and powdery mildew will attack the trees, as will pests like aphids, Japanese beetles, and leafhoppers.

Want to learn more? Check out these links:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Prunus_cerasifera

- https://minnetonkaorchards.com/purple-leaf-plum-tree/
- https://www.gardendesign.com/trees/purple-leaf-plum.html

As a reminder, the tree walk maps can be found here (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-walk-maps/), and the tree guides here (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-guide/).

Courtesy to Sunnyvale Forest Advocates (SUFA) for allowing us to reproduce their website content in our Villager. For more information, see their website at http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/

- Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt -

Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt

Welcome to the monthly scavenger hunt! Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to the three questions to vp1@lvnasv.org by November 30, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. ***The winner will get to choose a $10 gift card from World Wrapps, Wal-Mart, or Giovanni's Pizzeria.***

1. What is the name of the organization that offers Tree Walks in different parts of Sunnyvale?
    a. Sunnyvale Urban Forest Advocates
    b. Sunnyvale Urban Forest Allies
    c. Sunnyvale United Forest Alliance
2. True/False: Torrance Ave and Socorro Ave are both on the Lakewood side of the neighborhood..
    a. True.
    b. False.
3. How many houses are on the Charmwood Court cul-de-sac?
    a. 3
    b. 5
    c. 7
    d. 9

Answers from the October scavenger hunt:

1. *There are some City Council seats up for election in November. Which districts are they in? ANSWER: (c) Districts 3 and 5 (there was also an open seat for District 1, but only one person ran for that position, so in lieu of an election the City Council appointed that person to the seat)*
2. *True/False: Palamos Ave runs north-side on the Lakewood side of the neighborhood. ANSWER: (b) False.*
3. *There is a small shopping center at the corner of Fairwood Ave and Wildwood Ave. Which of these business is NOT located here? ANSWER: (b) Sifu Wong Kitchen*

LVNA CONTACTS

President	Lydia Fotiades	president@lvnasv.org
1st VP	Cortney Jansen	vp1@lvnasv.org
Treasurer	Linh Ly	treasurer@lvnasv.org
Secretary	Brad Dux	secretary@lvnasv.org

IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts & Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety - Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety - Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

Wanted

HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS AND LONG-TIME RESIDENTS

Hi neighbors,

I recently learned that there is no FHUSD high school in Sunnyvale north of El Camino Real (ECR). The only high school north of ECR (Sunnyvale High School) closed in 1981. I've joined a group of parents who are exploring the possibility of better supporting our high school students who live in North Sunnyvale. As a result, I'm looking to interview two groups of people. First, current high school students (or recent grads from high school) who can talk about their experience commuting to/from school, specifically what works well and what doesn't work well. Second, long-term residents who lived in Sunnyvale when the old high school was closed in 1981; I'd like to learn more about how the decision was made to close the school and what the community sentiment was at the time. If you fit in either of these groups (or are interested in helping to advocate for better opportunities for our high school students), please email me at cjbassoon@gmail.com

Thanks, Cortney

Upcoming Events

Nov

9

LVNA Monthly Meeting

In Person at the Lakewood Park Building

Dec

14

Good Neighbor Appreciation Event

In Person at the Lakewood Park Building

Find us on Nextdoor!

If you have not already joined the LVNA group on Nextdoor then we encourage you to do so. Nextdoor allows separate settings for group posts so it's an excellent way to get curated Lakewood Village-relevant content while filtering out the rest. Board members post reminders about upcoming events and moderators ensure all activity in the group adheres to the group's rules (e.g., content relevant to Lakewood Village, no soliciting, etc.). Note that only Lakewood Village residents are permitted to join.

To learn more or to join, visit nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap